

Week 12: Job Application Skills - Resumes and Cover Letters

Class ILO:

Write a resume and cover letter tailored for TSMC.

Tasks:

- **Learning Task:** Analyse sample resumes and cover letters.
- **Performance Task:** Draft a personal resume and cover letter for a TSMC job application.

Language Focus:

- Phrases: "Proficient in...", "Responsibilities included..."
- Vocabulary: Fabrication experience, team collaboration, technical expertise.

Session 1: Analysing and Understanding Resumes and Cover Letters

1. Warm-Up:

- **Discussion Prompt:**
 - "What do you think makes a strong resume and cover letter?"
 - "What skills and experiences might TSMC look for?"
 - Share a list of essential qualities for TSMC applicants (e.g., technical expertise, teamwork, communication skills).

2. Input Activity: Analysing Sample Documents:

• Step 1: Resume Analysis

- Read sample resumes, including one tailored for an engineering position at TSMC.
- Highlight key sections: Contact info, objective statement, skills, education, work experience.
- Discuss effective phrasing, such as:
 - "Proficient in designing automated processes."
 - "Responsibilities included supervising a fabrication team."

• Step 2: Cover Letter Analysis

- Read a model cover letter for a TSMC engineering role.
- Discuss structure:
 - **Opening:** State the purpose and interest in TSMC.
 - **Body:** Highlight qualifications and relevant experience.
 - **Closing:** Express enthusiasm and request an interview.
- Focus on specific language, e.g.,
 - "I am eager to contribute my fabrication expertise to TSMC."
 - "My previous role involved extensive collaboration with cross-functional teams."

3. Guided Practice:

- Work in pairs to identify strengths and weaknesses in the samples.
- Present your findings, emphasising effective language and layout.

4. Wrap-Up:

- Recap: What makes an effective resume and cover letter?

Session 2: Drafting Personal Resumes and Cover Letters

1. Warm-Up:

- Review the structure of resumes and cover letters using a visual diagram or checklist.

2. Learning Task: Identifying Personal Strengths :

- Read template and brainstorm:
 - **Skills:** (e.g., technical expertise, programming languages).
 - **Experiences:** (e.g., internships, projects, teamwork).
 - **Achievements:** (e.g., awards, certifications).
- Share your top 3 strengths with a partner.

3. Performance Task: Writing Drafts:

- **Resume Drafting:**
 - Use a template to draft your resumes tailored to TSMC.
 - Include:
 - Objective statement: “To contribute to TSMC as a skilled [role] with expertise in [skills].”
 - Key skills: "Proficient in fabrication processes and equipment troubleshooting."
 - Work experience: "Responsibilities included leading a 5-person team on a lithography optimization project."

- **Cover Letter Drafting:**

- Write an opening paragraph stating your interest in TSMC and your suitability for the role.
- Use language such as:
 - "My experience in semiconductor manufacturing aligns perfectly with TSMC's commitment to innovation."
 - "As an intern, I developed solutions to enhance yield rates by 15%."

4. Peer Review and Feedback:

- Exchange drafts with a peer for review.
- Consider a feedback rubric: Is the language formal? Are strengths clearly highlighted? Is the content tailored to TSMC?

5. Wrap-Up:

- Homework: Revise drafts based on peer feedback and prepare for submission.
- Reminder: Bring a polished version of both documents to the next class for further refinement.

Language Focus

- **Key Phrases for Resumes:**
 - "Proficient in..."
 - "Responsibilities included..."
 - "Achieved a 10% improvement in production efficiency."
- **Key Phrases for Cover Letters:**
 - "I am excited to apply my skills in [specific area] at TSMC."
 - "My fabrication experience includes..."
 - "I am confident that my expertise in [technical area] will make me a valuable addition to your team."
- **Vocabulary:**
 - Fabrication experience, yield improvement, cross-functional collaboration, technical expertise, quality assurance.

Assessment Criteria

- **Learning Task:**
 - Ability to Analyse sample resumes and cover letters, identifying effective and weak components.
- **Performance Task:**
 - A completed draft of a resume and cover letter tailored to TSMC.
 - Clear articulation of skills and experience using professional language.
 - Proper use of phrases and vocabulary relevant to the semiconductor industry.

This lesson builds real-world job application skills, directly aligned with TSMC's requirements and professional English communication standards.